

Disaster Risk Management Policy Diagnostic Tool

Evaluate a country's policy and institutional setting for Disaster Risk Management across six critical pillars

Prototype: this will be updated following test cases. Your feedback is welcomed.

Introduction

The objective of this web tool is to allow practitioners to conduct an assessment of the maturity of a country's Disaster Risk Management (DRM) system and identify the main policy gaps that may be constraining resilience-building efforts. Recognizing that a comprehensive DRM policy diagnostic requires a system-wide perspective, this tool is organized around the World Bank's DRM framework, which outlines six key DRM policy dimensions. The reader is referred to the accompanying Methodological Note for a thorough description of the DRM framework and this tool.

Legal and Institutional DRM Framework (Transversal)

Comprehensive policy reforms that establish or strengthen the legal and institutional foundations of DRM at national and subnational levels and across sectors.

Thematic Areas: DRM Policies and Institutions | Mainstreaming DRM into National Development Plans.

Risk Identification

Tools and processes to understand disaster risks, which are essential for guiding risk reduction and enabling data-informed policy reforms.

Risk Reduction

Proactive policy reforms to reduce existing hazard risks, prevent new ones, and enhance disaster resilience.

Thematic Areas: Territorial and Urban Planning | Public Investment Management | Sector-Specific Risk Reduction Measures.

Preparedness

Preparedness efforts to ensure that communities and governments are ready to act when a disaster occurs.

Thematic Areas: Early Warning Systems | Emergency Preparedness and Response | Adaptive Social Protection.

Financial Protection

Strategies and instruments designed to reduce the financial impact of disasters on governments, businesses, and households.

Thematic Areas: Fiscal Risk | Disaster Risk Financing Strategies and Instruments.

Resilient Reconstruction

Integration of resilience into recovery plans; prioritizing investments that reduce vulnerability.

This is a high-level assessment designed to be objective and quick. The tool assesses each DRM pillar using a set of closed Yes/No questions presented in an offline questionnaire. Users should review official documentation (legal, regulatory, institutional, and budgetary) and consult with colleagues and national authorities to provide an informed answer. This is particularly relevant for cross-cutting questions, where inputs from colleagues from sectors such as Water, Transport, Education, Health, and Agriculture may help in gathering information. Once all questions are completed, the web tool will generate key metrics and visual outputs.

Assessment Results

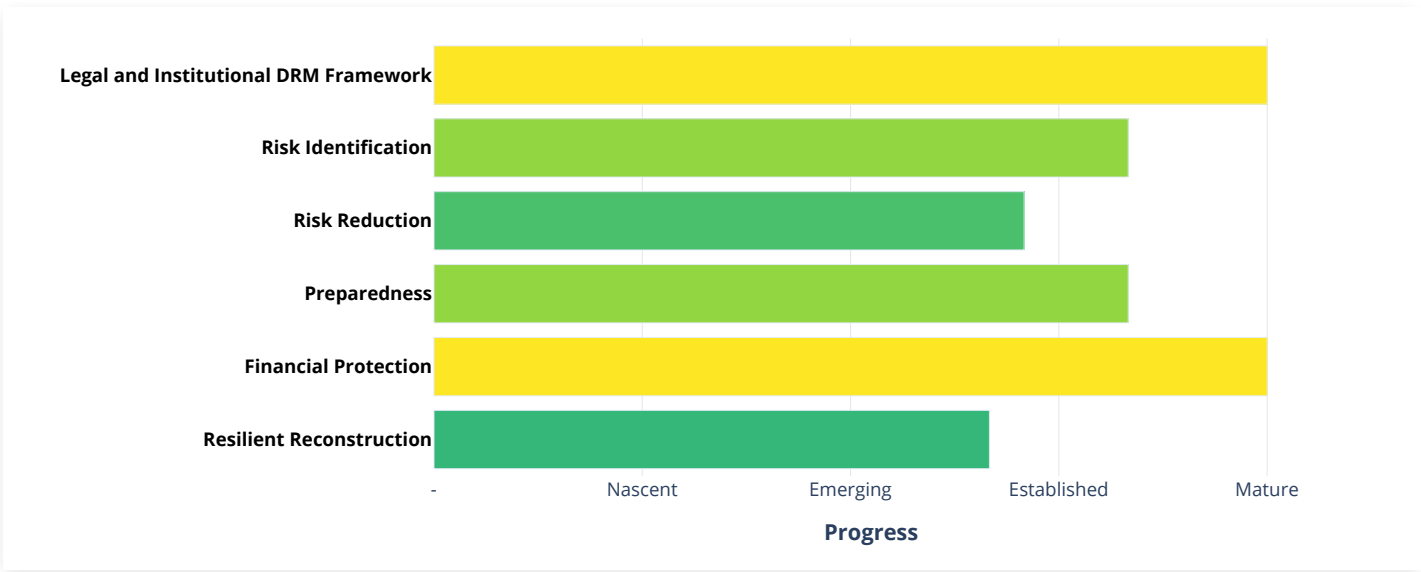
The petal diagram encapsulates the assessment results. Each petal represents a thematic area of the DRM framework, grouped by thematic area. Below the diagram, results are aggregated by DRM pillar to highlight key drivers and gaps.

- **Petal length** reflects progress in that thematic area: the longer the size of the petal, the more advanced the country is.
- **When a petal extends beyond the red circle**, minimum policy requirements for that area are considered in place.
- **Countries with mature DRM systems** typically have most petals exceeding the red circle, with some approaching the frontier (i.e., exhibiting a level of advances close to the global benchmark frontier).

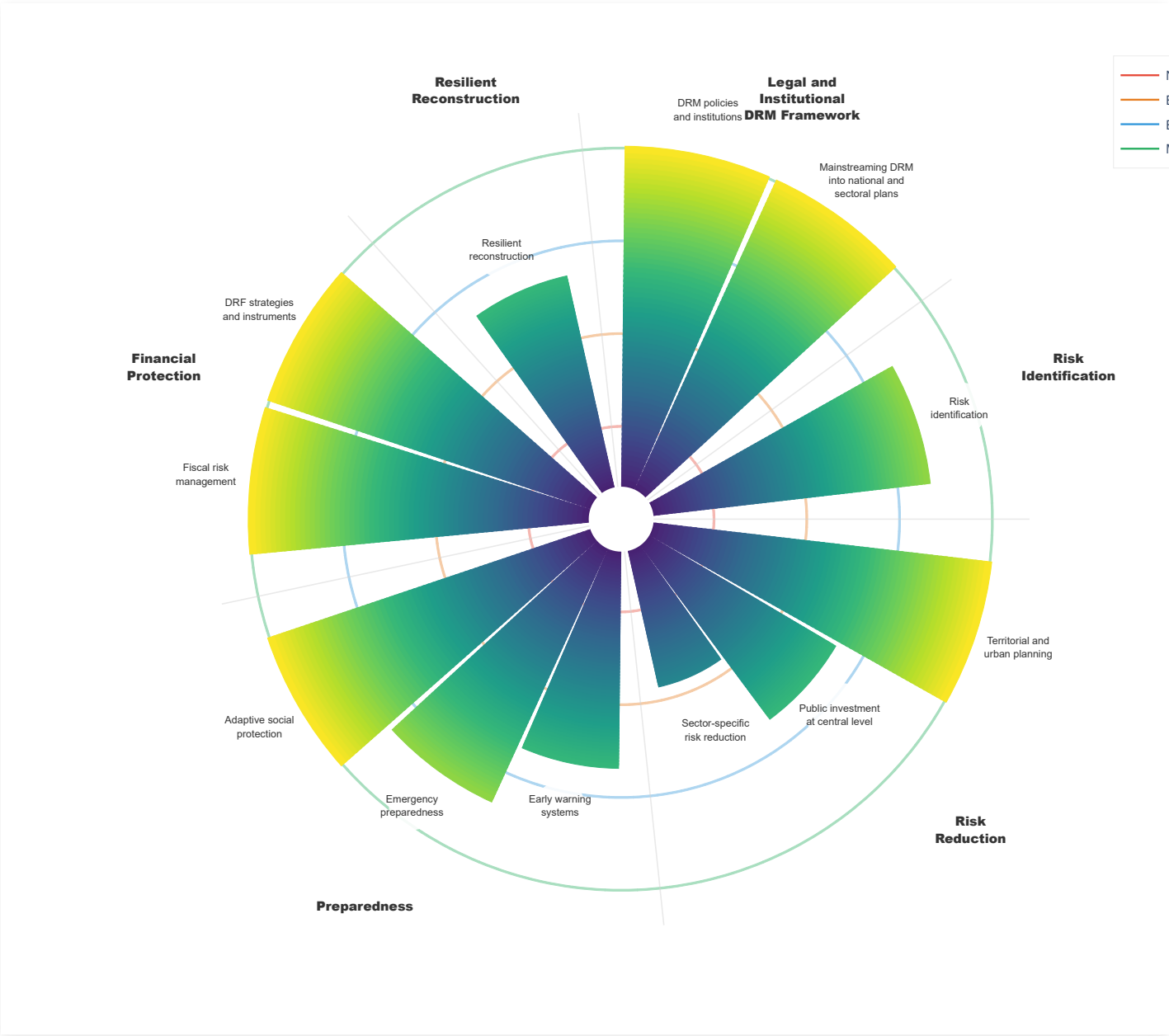
The diagnostic should be seen as a starting point for structuring a DRM policy dialogue—not as a final evaluation. Shorter petals indicate areas where the policy framework is weak and/or not producing the expected outcomes. Depending on a range of factors (e.g., political momentum, internal resources, country prioritization), this policy area may be prioritized for further support. Ultimately, this tool supports policy dialogue—whether to inform the preparation of a Cat DDO operation or to guide Technical Assistance—helping countries shift from reactive disaster response toward a proactive, strategic approach to managing disaster and climate-related risks.

While the evaluation reflects lessons learned and good practices that can serve as a foundation for a robust DRM policy framework, it should not be interpreted as prescriptive guidance. Disaster risk is highly context-specific, and this diagnostic represents only an initial step toward developing an appropriate and effective DRM policy program. Task teams are encouraged to consult the report [Driving Resilience Through Policy Reforms](#) for further guidance on how to structure a context-relevant DRM policy program.

Results by DRM Pillar



Results by Thematic Area



✓ **Congratulations! All assessed areas meet or exceed the minimum standard.**

i This text was generated automatically by a Large Language Model (LLM). Users should verify the content and cross-reference with official documentation.

DRM policies and institutions

In Colombia, all core components of the DRM institutional environment are in place: a legal framework, dedicated funding, a formally approved strategy, and up-to-date regulations. This combination indicates a mature and coherent system with clear roles, strategic direction, operational guidance, and financial support. Institutional capacity for DRM is likely to be strong.

Mainstreaming DRM into national and sectoral development plans

Both the national development strategy and the majority of essential government entities explicitly incorporate DRM or climate adaptation priorities in their strategic plans. This alignment demonstrates a strong mainstreaming of risk considerations across levels of government, supporting a coherent and coordinated approach to resilience.

Risk identification

In Colombia, institutional responsibilities are clear, government entities have access to data, and climate change impacts are considered. However, citizens cannot access hazard and risk information, suggesting strong governance and forward-looking analysis internally but limited transparency.

Territorial and urban planning

All core elements are in place: laws mandating risk use, official methodologies, guidelines for high-risk areas, and recent instruments incorporating risk information. This indicates a comprehensive, risk-informed approach to territorial and urban planning in Colombia.

Public investment at the central level

In Colombia, laws and official guidelines exist for disaster and climate risk screening, but mitigation measures are not mandatory. Screening is legally and technically supported, yet high-risk projects may still proceed without guaranteed risk reduction.

Sector-specific risk reduction measures

Transport, education, and health standards and hazard-resistant building codes exist, but energy infrastructure lacks standards. Roads, schools, hospitals, and buildings are resilient, though energy remains vulnerable. Retrofitting projects have been funded, but water and sanitation arrangements, integrated water management, watershed improvements, and sewage coverage are lacking. Some infrastructure is strengthened, but systemic water sector resilience is limited.

Early warning systems

In Colombia, institutions are coordinated and populations were promptly alerted, but there has been no budget allocation for the hydrometeorological network. Early warning operations reach the public effectively, but technical capacity and sustainability are limited.

Emergency preparedness and response

Legal framework, national protocols, and gender-sensitive measures exist, but subnational contingency plans are missing. National preparedness and inclusivity are strong, yet subnational capacity needs strengthening.

Adaptive social protection

A comprehensive adaptive social protection system is in place: legal framework, unified social registry, and timely support during disasters. Vulnerable populations are systematically targeted and assisted through well-coordinated ASP mechanisms.

Fiscal risk management

A comprehensive fiscal risk management system is in place: institutional structure, quantified disaster liabilities, fiscal documents with risk assessments, and stress tests including disaster and climate scenarios. Colombia demonstrates robust governance, analytical capacity, and preparedness for fiscal shocks.

DRF strategies and instruments

In Colombia, sovereign risk financing instruments, insurance regulations, and increased available financing are all in place. The country demonstrates strong financial preparedness to manage the impact of disasters and climate-related shocks.

Resilient reconstruction

Planning instruments are reviewed and assessment guidelines exist, but institutions are not defined. Reconstruction shows operational measures and assessment capacity, but lacks formal governance.

